

Tarotoo Tarot Card Meanings: A Complete 78-Card Structured Dataset

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Abstract. We present a complete, machine-readable dataset of tarot card meanings covering all 78 cards of the standard tarot deck (22 Major Arcana and 56 Minor Arcana) in the Rider–Waite–Smith tradition. Each card is described by 18 structured fields: identification (name, arcana, suit, numerological number), esoteric correspondences (element, planet, zodiac), tarot content (upright and reversed keywords and meanings, love, career, mood, and spiritual contexts), a yes/no value for binary readings, and a canonical reference URL. All interpretive text was created by Tarotoo within the Rider–Waite–Smith tradition, drawing on established public-domain sources, distributed under the MIT license, and validated by continuous integration. The dataset serves as the grounding corpus for the AI-generated readings on Tarotoo.com and is designed for retrieval-augmented generation, lookup services, and computational studies of tarot symbolism. It is distributed via GitHub, Hugging Face, Kaggle, npm, PyPI, and a Model Context Protocol server for direct use by AI assistants.

1. Introduction

Large language models are increasingly used to generate tarot readings, yet they typically draw card interpretations from opaque training data, producing inconsistent and unverifiable meanings. Publishing the interpretive corpus itself — openly and in structured form — allows readings to be grounded in a fixed, inspectable source, and allows anyone to verify what an AI system was told a card means. This dataset was created for exactly that purpose: it is the published source of card meanings used by the reading engine at Tarotoo.com. Beyond its primary role, a complete and consistently structured tarot corpus is useful for lookup services, conversational agents, and quantitative study of tarot symbolism.

2. Dataset Description

The dataset contains exactly 78 records — one per card: 22 Major Arcana (The Fool through The World) and 56 Minor Arcana across four suits (Wands, Cups, Swords, Pentacles), each running Ace through Ten plus four court cards (Page, Knight, Queen, King). Records are distributed in three equivalent formats: JSON (canonical, nested arrays for keywords), JSONL (one record per line), and CSV (flat, keyword lists joined with semicolons). Table 1 lists the schema.

Field	Type	Description
id	integer	Stable identifier, 0–77 (0–21 Major Arcana, then Wands, Cups, Swords, Pentacles)
name	string	Card name, e.g. “The Fool”, “Ace of Cups”
arcana	string	“major” or “minor”
suit	string null	null for Major Arcana; wands, cups, swords, pentacles
number_numerology	integer	Card number for numerology (courts: Page=11, Knight=12, Queen=13, King=14)
element	string	Classical element: Fire, Water, Air, Earth
planet	string null	Planetary association (null where not applicable, e.g. Aces)
zodiac	string null	Zodiac sign(s); the element's three signs for Aces and Pages

Field	Type	Description
yes_no	string	yes, no, or maybe — for yes-or-no readings
keywords_upright	list[string]	Upright keywords
keywords_reversed	list[string]	Reversed keywords
meaning_upright	string	Upright meaning as concise keyword phrases
meaning_reversed	string	Reversed meaning as concise keyword phrases
love	string	Love / relationships context
career	string	Career / work context
mood	string	Mood / emotional tone
spiritual	string	Spiritual-growth context
url	string	Card meaning page on tarotoo.com

Table 1: Dataset schema (18 fields per card).

3. Methodology

All interpretive text was created by Tarotoo within the Rider–Waite–Smith tradition and structured as concise keyword phrases suitable for both human reference and use in language-model prompts. The interpretations draw on established tarot sources, primarily A. E. Waite's *The Pictorial Key to the Tarot* (1911). Planetary and zodiac correspondences follow classical rulerships and the decan system documented in the Hermetic Order of the Golden Dawn's *Book T* (c. 1888–1897). Each card was reviewed for consistency in tone, terminology, structure, and level of detail across the complete deck. Published dataset files are generated from per-suit source files using a build script that checks schema completeness, including 78 unique card records, all 18 required fields, and valid field values. The build process regenerates each published format, while automated validation runs on every change made to the public repository.

4. Applications

Retrieval-augmented generation. The dataset's primary application is grounding AI tarot readings: when a user draws cards, the corresponding records are retrieved and included in the model prompt, anchoring the generated interpretation to published meanings. This is the production configuration on Tarotoo.com. **Live access for AI assistants.** A companion Model Context Protocol (MCP) server exposes lookup, search, yes/no, and card-drawing tools to MCP-capable AI assistants; it is listed in the official MCP registry as `io.github.Tarotoo-com/tarotoo-mcp-server`. **Software libraries.** The dataset ships as installable packages for JavaScript (npm: `tarotoo-tarot`) and Python (PyPI: `tarotoo-tarot`) with lookup and search helpers. **Analysis.** The consistent schema supports studies of keyword distributions, elemental and astrological correspondence patterns, and cross-suit symbolism.

5. Availability

The dataset is published under the MIT license. The source of truth is the GitHub repository (github.com/Tarotoo-com/tarotoo-tarot-dataset); versioned archives with DOIs are deposited on Zenodo (concept DOI [10.5281/zenodo.21268290](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.21268290), which always resolves to the latest version). Mirrors and packages: Hugging Face (huggingface.co/datasets/Tarotoo/tarotoo-tarot-card-meanings), Kaggle (kaggle.com/datasets/tarotoo/tarotoo-tarot-card-meanings), npm and PyPI (`tarotoo-tarot`), and the MCP server (github.com/Tarotoo-com/tarotoo-mcp-server). A human-readable overview with all links is maintained at tarotoo.com/open-data.

6. Limitations and Responsible Use

The dataset encodes one widely used interpretive tradition; other tarot traditions assign different meanings and correspondences, and no claim is made that these interpretations are exhaustive or authoritative beyond that tradition. Tarot readings — whether generated by humans or AI systems — are for entertainment and self-reflection only, and are not a substitute for medical, legal, financial, or mental-health advice.

References

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